

LEXSHIELD

User Manual

For LEXSHIELD administrators, lawyers, and clients

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1. Welcome to LEXSHIELD

LEXSHIELD

LEXSHIELD is a web-based legal services and secure client collaboration platform. The current implementation provides separate role-based workspaces for administrators, lawyers, and clients, plus public lawyer discovery and account-access pages.

Who should use this manual

Administrators use the Admin Dashboard and administration tools. Lawyers use the Lawyer Dashboard, Case Files, Appointments, Messages, and Profile. Clients use the Client Dashboard, Lawyers directory, Payments, Billing, Profile, Case Files, Messages, and Appointments.

Important scope note

This manual reflects the features and labels found in the supplied LEXSHIELD source code. It removes the draft placeholders that were not supported by the code. Exact deployment URL, support contacts, browser minimum versions, and environment-specific credentials are intentionally not invented.

2. Before You Begin

Requirements

Use a modern web browser with internet access. The application loads its own CSS/JavaScript and uses external font/CDN resources in the current implementation. A stable connection is recommended for document and payment-proof uploads.

Accounts

Client self-registration is available. Lawyer and administrator accounts are role-based accounts managed through the system; the supplied code does not provide a public self-registration flow for lawyers or administrators.

Security preparation

Keep your account credentials private. Do not use a shared/public computer for sensitive work unless necessary, and log out when finished.

File preparation

Case-file documents support PDF, JPG, PNG, WEBP, and DOCX, with a maximum document size of 25 MB. Payment proof supports PNG, JPEG, WEBP, GIF, and PDF, with an 8 MB limit.

3. Accounts, Registration & Login

Client registration

1) Open the registration page. 2) Enter the requested client information, including name, email, contact number, city/address information, and password. 3) Submit the registration form. 4) LEXSHIELD sends a 6-digit email verification code when registration OTP is enabled. 5) Enter the code to complete registration. The verification code expires after 10 minutes; repeated incorrect verification attempts are limited.

Login

1) Open the Login page. 2) Enter email and password. 3) Submit the login form. 4) When login verification is enabled by the deployment, enter the 4-digit code sent to the registered email. The login verification screen has a 3-minute countdown and a resend option. 5) After successful authentication, the user is routed to the workspace for their role.

Forgot password

Use Forgot Password from the Login page. The reset flow uses a single-use reset link with a 10-minute expiration. The new password is stored as a hash.

Logout

Use Logout in the sidebar to end the authenticated session.

4. User Roles & Navigation

Administrator navigation

Dashboard; Messages; Inquiries; Lawyers; Clients; Payments; Phishing Scans; Audit Logs; Settings; Logout.

Lawyer navigation

Dashboard; Profile; Case Files; Appointments; Messages; Logout.

Client navigation

Dashboard; Lawyers; Payments; Billing; Profile; Case Files; Messages; Appointments; Logout.

Access principle

The application enforces role-specific access through server-side role checks. A user should only see and access the workspace appropriate to the authenticated role.

5. Public Home & Lawyer Directory

Home page

The public home page presents LEXSHIELD as a legal-services platform and provides navigation for Home, Lawyers, Services, About, and Contact. It also exposes portal access and appointment entry points.

Lawyer directory

Clients can browse active lawyers, search by name-related terms, and filter by specialization. Lawyer cards can show profile information, specialization, rating/review count, roll number, joined information, and availability status.

Lawyer profile and booking

A client can open a lawyer profile and use Book when the lawyer is eligible for appointment requests. If a lawyer is busy or inactive, the Book control can be disabled.

6. Administrator Portal

Dashboard

The Admin Dashboard summarizes Total Cases, Active Lawyers, Open Cases, and client risk coverage. It also shows Risk Overview, Security Activity, top failed IPs, Recent Cases, and an Audit Feed.

Lawyer management

The Lawyers administration area is used to manage lawyer records and related information. The exact fields shown are deployment-dependent, but the supplied source includes lawyer profile, specialization, bar/roll information, contact details, background, reviews, status, and busy/availability state.

Client management

The Clients administration area is used to review/manage client records. Client records include account information and a risk level field.

Payments

The Admin Payments page provides payment totals and filters for All, Pending, Verified, and Rejected. Admins can search by client name/email, payment purpose, or reference number and open a payment for review. [Inquiries](#)

The Admin Inquiries page provides access to public/contact inquiries submitted through the platform.

Messages

The Admin Messages area provides administrative access to message conversations available to the admin role.

Phishing Scans

The Phishing Scans area records URL scan results and suspicious/phishing findings generated by the platform's phishing detector.

Audit Logs

Audit Logs provide a record of security and system actions, including events such as registrations, failed logins, OTP failures/expiry, appointment booking, rejected uploads, malware scanning events, and other audited actions.

Settings

System Settings is the administrative configuration area. The supplied code includes configurable GCash payment details/instructions used by the client payment page.

7. Lawyer Portal

Dashboard

The Lawyer Dashboard shows assigned cases, upcoming appointments, unread messages, unique clients, profile details, recent appointments, and assigned-case information.

Profile

Lawyers can access their profile and edit profile information. The implementation includes lawyer-specific information such as specialization, bar number, contact number, background/profile details, and avatar support.

Case Files

Lawyers can open case files assigned to them, review case details, documents, and message history, and work with the case-file document vault.

Appointments

Lawyers can review appointment requests and schedules associated with their cases. Appointment records include scheduled date/time, appointment type, status, and notes.

Messages

Lawyers can use the Messages workspace to communicate with clients and send attachments. Conversations can be associated with a case and can be marked important, muted, or unread.

Tip: Screen labels can vary slightly with the deployment configuration, but the role-specific routes and core behaviors above are present in the supplied source.

8. Client Portal

Dashboard

The Client Dashboard is the main client workspace for accessing the client's legal-service activity.

Lawyers

Use the Lawyers directory to find an active lawyer, filter by specialization, review profile information, and start an appointment request when booking is available.

Appointments

To request an appointment: 1) Choose a lawyer. 2) Select a future date. 3) Select a time. 4) Select an appointment type: Client Intake Consultation, Document Review, Case Follow-up, or Legal Advice. 5) Add optional notes. 6) Submit the request. New appointment requests are stored with a pending status. If the client has no existing case with that lawyer, the system can automatically create an intake case.

Profile

Use Profile to view/edit the client profile information supported by the application.

Billing and Payments

Billing provides case-related billing information, while Payments is the workflow for submitting GCash payment proof and viewing payment history.

9. Case Files & Document Vault

Case file list

The Case Files area provides a searchable, filterable list of case files. Case records can show client name, case identifier, case title, status, assigned lawyer, and creation date. Status values include Open, Ongoing, and Closed.

Creating a case file

Authorized users can create a case file by selecting a client, assigned lawyer, status, and case information. The interface supports an attachment category selection including Documents, Photos, Evidence, Court Filings, and Correspondence.

Folders

Each case file can contain a document vault with folders. The default folder descriptions in the source include Documents, Photos, Evidence, Court Filings, and Correspondence. Users with permission can create additional folders.

Uploading documents

1) Open the relevant case. 2) Open the document vault. 3) Choose the destination folder. 4) Select Upload Document. 5) Choose the file. 6) Submit the upload. Supported types are PDF, JPG, PNG, WEBP, and DOCX; maximum size is 25 MB.

Document processing

The server validates the upload type, scans the uploaded file for malware when the configured scanner is available, calculates a SHA-256 hash, and encrypts case documents before storage using AES-256-GCM. The document record stores encryption metadata and upload/approval status.

Document actions

Depending on the user's role and the document state, the interface can provide Preview, Download, Rename, Approve, Reject, and Delete actions.

Approval state

Case-file documents include an upload status and can record the user who approved the document and the approval timestamp.

10. Secure Messaging

Start a conversation

Open Messages. Existing conversations can be filtered as All, Unread, or Important. A new message can be created by selecting a lawyer and entering a message; a file can optionally be attached.

Send a message

1) Open or create the conversation. 2) Type the message. 3) Optionally attach a file. 4) Select Send.

Attachments

Message attachments support PDF, JPG, PNG, WEBP, and DOCX under the application's upload validation rules. The message system records attachment metadata and supports downloadable attachments.

Conversation controls

The message workspace supports conversation preferences including Important, Muted, and Unread states. The source also includes message deletion support.

Case context

Messages can be associated with a case, allowing communication to remain connected to the relevant legal matter.

11. Payments & Billing

Client payment setup

The Payments page uses manual GCash transfer. When the administrator has configured the GCash account details and QR image, the page displays the GCash QR, account name, GCash number, and payment instructions.

Submit payment proof

1) Open Payments. 2) Review the GCash payment instructions. 3) Pay using the displayed QR code or account details. 4) Enter Payment for, payer name, payer contact, amount in PHP, and optional GCash reference number. 5) Upload proof of payment. 6) Add optional notes. 7) Submit.

Payment-proof files

Accepted proof formats are PNG, JPEG, WEBP, GIF, and PDF. The maximum size is 8 MB.

Review status

Submitted payments are stored with a status such as Pending, Verified, or Rejected. The client can view payment history and any available admin note/reviewer information.

Administrator review

Admins can filter/search payment records, open a payment review page, and verify or reject submitted payment proof. Pending payments are prioritized in the review list.

12. Security & Compliance Features

Authentication security

Passwords are stored as hashes. Password-reset links are single-use and expire after 10 minutes. Client registration uses a 6-digit email OTP when enabled; login verification uses a 4-digit email code when enabled.

Session and request protection

The application starts secure sessions and uses CSRF tokens on protected forms. It also sets security-related HTTP headers including X-Content-Type-Options, X-Frame-Options, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy, and Content-Security-Policy.

Rate limiting and logout

The application includes rate limiting for protected actions and login defenses. The Admin Dashboard reports failed logins and currently locked accounts.

Upload security

Uploads are checked against allowed file types and size limits. The storage layer can use ClamAV for malware scanning. Rejected uploads and malware-scan events can be recorded in the audit trail.

Case-document encryption

Case-file documents are encrypted at rest using AES-256-GCM before being stored. Encryption IV/tag metadata is stored with the document record.

Auditability

Security and operational events are written to audit logs, providing an administrative trail for review.

Phishing detector

The platform includes a Phishing Detector that accepts a URL for scanning and stores scan findings for administrative review.

13. Troubleshooting & FAQs

I cannot log in.

Check your email and password. If the login verification screen appears, enter the 4-digit code sent to your email. If you forgot the password, use Forgot Password. Repeated failed login attempts can trigger security restrictions.

My registration code expired.

Registration OTPs expire after 10 minutes. Use the resend-code option to request a new verification code.

My login verification code expired.

The login verification interface uses a 3-minute countdown. Use Resend Code or restart the login flow.

My case document will not upload.

Confirm the file is PDF, JPG, PNG, WEBP, or DOCX and is no larger than 25 MB. Also confirm your connection is stable. The server may reject files that fail type validation or malware scanning.

My payment proof will not upload.

Confirm the proof is PNG, JPEG, WEBP, GIF, or PDF and no larger than 8 MB.

I cannot book an appointment.

Make sure the selected lawyer is active/available and that the selected date/time is in the future. Appointment requests are created with Pending status.

I cannot see a feature.

Check your account role. LEXSHIELD uses separate Admin, Lawyer, and Client navigation and server-side role checks.

I need to report a suspicious URL.

Use the Phishing Detector where available, or notify the administrator through the firm's established support process.

14. Support & Deployment Notes

Support details

The supplied source code does not contain a final public support email, phone number, office hours, or deployment URL. These should be inserted by the project team before distribution.

Recommended finalization

Before publishing this manual, capture screenshots from the deployed application for Login, Client Registration/OTP, Admin Dashboard, Lawyer Dashboard, Client Dashboard, Case Files, Document Vault, Messages, Appointments, Payments, and Phishing Detector. Replace any environment-specific labels with the exact deployed values.

Version basis

This revised manual is based on the supplied LEXSHIELD source code and the draft PDF provided for correction. It is intended to replace the structural draft's unsupported placeholders with behavior that is visible in the current implementation.